



Doi Inthanon

Doi Inthanon (Thai: ดอยอินทนนท์, pronounced [dǔj ʔin.tʰā.nǒn]) is the highest mountain in Thailand.^[2] It is in Chom Thong District, Chiang Mai Province. This mountain is an ultra prominent peak, known in the past as **Doi Luang Ang Ga** (*Grand Mount Ang Ga*) or meaning the 'crow's pond top'. Near the mountain's base was a pond where many crows gathered. The name *Doi Inthanon* was given in honour of Inthawichayanon, Grand Prince of Chiang Mai, who was concerned about the forests in the north and tried to preserve them. After his death, his remains were interred at Doi Luang, which was then renamed in his honour.

Today, the summit of Doi Inthanon is a popular tourist destination for both foreign and Thai tourists, with a peak of 12,000 visitors visiting the summit on New Year's Day. In addition to a range of tourist facilities on the summit, there is a weather station operated by the Royal Thai Air Force, with the Thai National Observatory also based there.^[3]

Geography

Doi Inthanon is the highest peak of the Inthanon Range (Thai: ทิวเขาอินทนนท์) of the Thanon Thong Chai Range, a subrange of the Shan Hills in the Thai highlands stretching southwards from the Daen Lao Range. This range, the southwesternmost of the Shan Highland system, separates the Salween watershed from the Mekong watershed. Other high peaks of the Daen Lao Range are Doi Luang Chiang Dao (2,175 metres (7,136 ft)), Doi Pui (1,685 metres (5,528 ft)), and Doi Suthep (1,601 metres (5,253 ft)).

Doi Inthanon



Naphamethinidon and Naphaphonphumisiri, two chedis near the summit of Doi Inthanon

Highest point

Elevation	2,565 m (8,415 ft)
Prominence	1,835 m (6,020 ft) ^[1]
Listing	Country high point List of Ultras of Southeast Asia Ribu
Coordinates	18°35′15″N 98°29′12″E﻿ / ﻿

Geography



Thailand

Location	Chiang Mai, Thailand
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In 1954, the forests around Doi Inthanon were conserved, creating Doi Inthanon National Park, as one of the original 14 national parks of Thailand.^[4] This park now covers 482.4 km² and spreads from the lowlands at 800 metres (2,625 ft) elevation up to the peak at 2,565 metres (8,415 ft). Given the varied climatic and ecological areas regions, the park supports a range of animal species, including around 500 bird species.^[5]

<u>Parent range</u>	<u>Shan Hills</u>
Geology	
<u>Mountain type</u>	<u>granite batholith</u>
Climbing	
<u>Easiest route</u>	drive

On the lower slopes of Doi Inthanon, near the Karen hill tribe village, Ban Sop Had, are the Wachirathan waterfalls (Thai: น้ำตกวชิรธาร), where the Wachirathan (lit. "Diamond Creek") tumbles over a granite escarpment. (18.541790°N 98.599247°E)

Climate

The climate is typically tropical and fairly cool on the summit of Doi Inthanon. In the winter, the average temperature is 6 °C (43 °F) in January and temperatures can sometimes drop below 0 °C (32 °F). On 21 December 2017, an all-time low temperature of −5 °C (23 °F) was recorded at 06:30 at km 44.4.^[6] From March to June, temperatures are pleasant, especially at higher altitudes. The rainy season runs from April to November when it sometimes rains for more than two hours daily.

Geology

Geologically the mountain is a granite batholith in a north–south oriented mountain range. The second-highest peak of this range is Doi Hua Mot Luang at 2,340 metres (7,677 ft).

Environmental issues

In 2014, visitors to the mountain left behind 36 tonnes (35 long tons; 40 short tons) of rubbish.^[7]

Places

- On the summit of Doi Inthanon stands a stupa that contains Inthawichayanon's ashes.^[8]
- On the main road to the summit of Doi Inthanon stand two adjacent chedis, one called *Naphamethinidon* (นพเมธีนิธด), meaning 'by the strength of the land and air', and the other, *Naphaphonphumisiri* (นพพลภูมิสิริ), meaning 'being the strength of the air and the grace of the land'. These temples were built to honor the 60th birth anniversary of King Bhumibol Adulyadej in 1987, and the 60th birth anniversary of Queen Sirikit in 1992, respectively.^[9]
- Kio Mae Pan Nature Trail^[10]
- The Inthanon Royal Project Research Station: The agricultural station was a King Bhumibol Adulyadej project to help eliminate opium cultivation. It contains a rhododendron garden, and greenhouses for growing ferns, flowering plants, and vegetables.^[10]

Gallery



5th Unit Doi Inthanon National Park



Stupa of Inthawichayanon



View west from Doi Inthanon



View from the Royal Pagoda



Vegetation on the slopes of Doi Inthanon



Wachirathan Waterfall



Mural carvings on King's Pagoda



Royal Chedi



View from the top



Doi Inthanon control and reporting center on the summit

See also

- [List of mountains in Thailand](#)
- [List of Southeast Asian mountains](#)
- [List of ultras of Southeast Asia](#)
- [Doi Inthanon rock frog](#)
- [List of elevation extremes by country](#)

References

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External links

-  Doi Inthanon National Park travel guide from Wikivoyage
- [thaibirding.com](http://www.thaibirding.com/locations/north/doi_int.htm) on Doi Inthanon (http://www.thaibirding.com/locations/north/doi_int.htm)
- [www.DoiInthanon.net](https://web.archive.org/web/20120405231247/http://www.doiinthanon.net/) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120405231247/http://www.doiinthanon.net/>)
- "Doi Inthanon, Thailand" on Peakbagger (<http://www.peakbagger.com/peak.aspx?pid=10952>)

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